

FALLS

From B1
period and 2-of-19 the second. By halftime, they were scratching their heads in disbelief and trailed, 31-14. Olmsted Falls had 28 rebounds in the first half alone, 10 better than Firelands. Schaefer was a load inside. He scored 15 of Falls' first 19 points by planting himself inside, waiting for the lob pass or rebound. If Firelands fouled him, he would make the free throws (5-of-5).

"Our game plan was to get the ball inside whenever we can," said Schaefer. "Firelands adjusted, but I think we set a record hitting 3's the third quarter. It was unbelievable."

In the third period, it was Matt Tabor's turn with a 3-point show. Tabor buried three quick long-range attempts before missing.

But guess what? Schaefer was right there for the tip-in as the Bulldogs rolled to a 42-20 advantage that soon became 50-20 as Falls ripped off another set of 3's by Tim Matus and John Storey and a driving layup by Matus. All told, Falls had seven 3's in the period, a figure most teams would be proud to have in a game.

"Schaefer really opened it up," said Tabor. "We sort of hopped on his back the first

Olmsted Falls					Firelands				
G	F	T	3P	FT	G	F	T	3P	FT
Schaefer	21	12	7	21	Collier	3	3	1	9
Tabor	12	12	3	10	Thornsbury	3	3	1	9
Storey	8	8	2	10	Engel	0	0	0	0
Neumaier	4	4	0	10	Capenza	0	0	0	0
Higgins	2	2	0	10	Gibson	0	0	0	0
Matus	0	0	0	10	Solomon	0	0	0	0
Morrison	0	0	0	10	Burden	0	0	0	0
Kalmbach	0	0	0	10	Taney	0	0	0	0
Pelton	0	0	0	10	Corley	0	0	0	0
Radgen	0	0	0	10	Altop	0	0	0	0
Moore	0	0	0	10	Flynn	0	0	0	0
Stephens	0	0	0	10	Vardeh	0	0	0	0
Totals	27	15	15	100	Totals	3	3	1	41

half. It took the pressure off him in the third quarter when we hit some 3's."

Tabor had 12 points, and five teammates added at least five points apiece as Falls hit half of its 54 floor attempts, including 10 3's and 15-of-17 (88 percent) free throws.

Falls finished with 51 rebounds to 33 for the Falcons. If not for eight Bulldog turnovers in the first period and 23 on the night, the margin could have been even more one-sided.

Mike Collier and Nick Thornsbury, who terrorized the Lorain County Conference all year for the Falcons, scored only nine apiece. Firelands, normally a very good shooting team, netted just 9-of-67 shots (13 percent) from the floor and 12-of-21 (57 percent) free throws. Firelands turned the ball over only 12 times.

"It was a great year," said



KIMBERLY BARTH / CHRONICLE

REAL STOREY: Olmsted Falls' John Storey grabs the basketball under pressure from Firelands' Adam Engel Wednesday in district action at Admiral King.

Horne. "We don't want to put a damper on things. We played tough all year. We were in the thick of things (Lorain County

Conference). I'm happy with it. I think the kids gave everything they had. That's all you can ask for."

open a 49-30 edge.

The lead was reduced to as few as a dozen points in the fourth quarter, but the Eagles canned all but one of 13 free throw shots to keep Amherst at bay.

Kris White paced the Comets with 17 points. Todd Damasiewicz grabbed seven rebounds. Damasiewicz, who scored 30 points in a sectional game against North Ridgeville, was held to seven points.

Amherst					St. Ed				
G	F	T	3P	FT	G	F	T	3P	FT
White	6	17	5	17	Lepore	4	0	0	5
Diadok	1	5	7	10	Jackson	4	0	0	6
Duho	2	0	5	10	Logan	4	10	18	
Damasiewicz	3	1	2	10	Barbion	9	6	26	
Luger	1	0	2	10	Clancy	1	2	4	
Rich	2	1	5	10	Holmes	1	0	2	
Burke	2	2	7	10	Latkovic	1	0	3	
Pena	1	0	2	10	Rumrill	3	5	5	
Totals	18	11	32	100	Totals	23	21	71	

Points by Quarters					T				
1	2	3	4	T	1	2	3	4	T
Amherst	8	11	12	—	32				
St. Edward	16	12	21	—	71				

Three-point goals: White 3, Barbolone 2, Lepore, Duho, Latkovic, Burke

AMHERST

From B1
St. Ed's 10 over that time.

Amherst finished its season with a 16-6 record. St. Edward is now 18-4.

"I've seen them when they've shot the lights out," Zimmerman said. "We were lucky they didn't shoot well tonight. They have a lot of kids who can shoot 3-pointers."

But luck had nothing to do with the Eagles burying 21-of-23 free throws or getting 44 points from the backcourt of junior Gino Bartolone and sophomore Steve Logan.

"There were three keys to this game, and they were control Logan, control Bartolone

and handle the press," Zvara said. "We didn't do any of those."

St. Ed's big guys, Sam Clancy and Jay Jackson, were not that great a factor. Clancy had four points and five rebounds. Jackson scored eight and speared four rebounds.

"I consider our guards two of the best in the state," Zimmerman said. "Logan is a big-time point guard. He could be a big scorer, but he'd rather run the show."

"Bartolone has ice in his veins," Zimmerman added. "He might look like a choir boy but he's really tough, too. Amherst decided to give up something on defense, so they gave up Gino and Steve."

Bartolone scored 26 points

and Logan had 18. Logan sank 10 of 11 at the foul line.

"It wasn't one of our better games," Zvara said, "but it was a good effort and St. Ed has a nice team. Things happened in the second half that we knew we couldn't have happen and win."

The Comets fell behind 28-10 with 2:44 to go before halftime as the Eagles enjoyed a 14-1 run. But Amherst scored the final 10 points of the first half, eight of them in the last 41 seconds, to get back in the chase.

Amherst was down by only nine points with a minute left in the third quarter, but the full-court press of the Eagles wrecked havoc in the Comets' backcourt as St. Ed scored 10 points in the last 43 seconds to

Pirate prospect has major hurdle

Jerry Rombach
The Chronicle-Telegram

BRADENTON, FLA.— This is a pivotal year in the baseball future of Tarrence Staton.

Is a Pittsburgh Pirate uniform being sized up, or will he be shopping around for another fit next winter?

The man who led Elyria West to the 1992 Ohio state baseball championship is entering his fourth and possibly last year in the Pittsburgh Pirates' minor league organization. This season could determine whether he remains with the Pirates or goes elsewhere in his dream to make the major leagues.

It's a rare honor Staton is pursuing. No Elyrian has made it to the big leagues since Tom Norton played with the Minnesota Twins in 1972. And you have to go back another 18 years, 1954, to find the previous major leaguer from Elyria, Vic Janowicz.

"This is my last protection year," Staton said on Tuesday during a rare afternoon off for the minor league squad. "If they don't place me on their 40-man spring training roster next season I'll be a free agent to go anywhere."

If that happens, agent Myles Shoda of Atlanta will shop around to see what other major league organization might be more suited to getting Staton in a big league uniform.

Already the Pirates have shown great faith in Staton's potential to make the big league team. They invited him to spring training with an elite group of 25 top minor league prospects. It's called the "early group" and is separated from the rest of the minor league contingent that came to Bradenton last weekend. The early group reported Feb. 14, three days before Staton's 21st birthday.

Director of Minor League Operations Pete Vuckovich reflects that confidence.

"Tarrence wouldn't have been invited to the early camp if we didn't see the potential in him," he said. "Now we'll just have to wait and see what happens. So far, we're very pleased with his work. He's doing just fine. We're not disappointed in anything."

Staton, 6-foot-3 and 200 pounds, was a power hitter in high school, and his physique suggests that potential in the big leagues. Yet, last year at Augusta, Ga., in the South Atlantic League, he hit only five home runs in 391 at-

bats. "We don't pay any attention to numbers at this stage of a young man's career," Vuckovich said. "He hit .292 last year, so he proved he can play. We're experienced in watching young players. We look for little things here and there. The stats don't worry us. Tarrence has genuine, raw power. He can hit some long ones. We've seen him."

"You check it out. Check the home run totals for Barry Bonds and others at the same stage of their careers as Staton. They didn't hit home runs in big numbers at that level, either."

Staton's .292 average helped Augusta win the Class A league championship. The Green Jacks beat Columbus, Ga., in the first playoff and knocked off Piedmont in three straight games to get the title, the first in Augusta history.

"Everything is going all right," Staton said of spring training. "We'll start our regular minor league spring training schedule on March 16. I'm looking forward to it. I feel healthy and ready to go."

"Since this is my last protection year I've got to do what it takes. The only big difference between players in the big leagues and the minors is consistency. My primary goal this year is consistency."

Vuckovich feels Staton is solid in right field, but figures eventually he'll play left field in the majors. "He has a good arm, but not quite strong enough to be a right fielder in the majors," Vuckovich said.

Already they are working Staton in left.

"I've been in left field the last two days at practice," Staton said. "It's not too much different. The main adjustment is learning to go to your left instead of your right on line drives."

The minor league team assignments will not be announced until early in April.

"I think he's proven himself at Augusta," Vukovich said. "So my guess is he'll probably be assigned to Class A at Lynchburg in the Carolina League. But that is definitely not set."

Staton had 114 hits, tops on the team, at Augusta last summer. His 21 doubles and five triples were both runners-up for team honors, as were his 53 runs batted in.

During the fall he played in a special league for top prospects, in Honolulu, where he batted .282. The season was over by Christmas, in time for him to spend a little of the off season at home with his mother. He has a girl friend attending Eastern Michigan University.

BOYS BASKETBALL PREVIEW

Elyria West vs. Rocky River

WHAT: Admiral King Division II district semifinal
WHERE: Admiral King High School, 2600 Ashland Ave., Lorain
WHEN: 7 p.m. tip-off
SEASON TO DATE:
Elyria West— 16-3 overall; Midview 51-36, Olmsted Falls 33-62, Bay Village 67-51, Westlake 71-55, Brookside 67-48, Avon 61-53, North Ridgeville 67-40, Keystone 52-44, Clearview 73-54, Firelands 75-73 (2OT), Wellington 78-50, Oberlin 73-66, Brookside 72-42, Avon 64-48, Keystone 54-33, Clearview 47-49, Firelands 53-54, Wellington 60-45, Avon Lake 64-46, Oberlin 68-54, Avon Lake, 50-40.
With a victory tonight, the Wolverines will set the school record for victories in a season that they currently share with the 1977-78 and 1983-84 teams.
Rocky River— 13-9, Oberlin 62-72, Bay Village 56-49, Olmsted Falls 64-87, Westlake 46-45, Amherst 47-59, St. Ignace 46-49, North Olmsted 48-41, Midpark 59-44, Fairview 57-31, North Royalton 43-49, Avon Lake 46-49, Lutheran West 47-50, Bay Village 69-55, Olmsted Falls 52-71, Westlake 67-41, Amherst 55-53, North Olmsted 36-60, Fairview 71-58, Avon Lake 66-51, Highland 54-53, Keystone 62-36.
The Pirates crushed Keystone in their last outing Saturday after a narrow win over Highland in the tournament opener. Freshman Jeff Peate (11 points), sophomore Matt Ferguson (10) and senior Brad Niksa (10) led River's scoring against Keystone but Chad Standing leads the team in scoring (14 points per game).
LAST TIME: The schools haven't played since the 1993-94 season when Rocky River won at the Baldwin-Wallace sectional, 58-46. Rocky River went on to win the district that year, ironically beating Olmsted Falls, 44-42, before being eliminated 51-44 by Fostoria at the Toledo regional.
COACHES COMMENTS:
Elyria West coach Mitch Gillam: "Rocky River has won nine of its last 11 and has beaten some quality teams. They're very capable. Standing averages 14-15 a game and the freshman (Peate) is very impressive. They seem to have someone new step up each game. I was impressed with the way they played (Keystone). We'll have to take our game faces with us. We have to stay focused and not let our minds drift."
Rocky River coach Jim Rucki: "We feel when we play well, we can play with most teams. Most teams have an advantage on us in one area and we have an advantage in some other area. We have to do our best to exploit our advantage. We hadn't thought much about them (before this week) but I'm sure we'll come up with something."
PROBABLE STARTING LINEUPS:
Elyria West
CENTER— Brian Jenkins, 6-6 sr.
FORWARDS— Brad Schnell, 6-3 sr. and Rob Woolbricht, 6-3 sr.
GUARDS— Daimon Mahone, 5-11 sr. and Nate Crutcher, 6-4 sr.
Rocky River
CENTER— Eboisa Kasic, 6-5 sr. or Casey Dolan 6-1 sr.
FORWARDS— Brad Niksa, 5-10 sr. and Chad Standing 6-0 sr.
GUARDS— Jeff Peate, 5-11 fr. and Sean Kennedy 6-2 so.
NEXT GAME: The winner of tonight's game will play top-seeded Olmsted Falls Saturday at 7 p.m. for the district championship and trip to the Toledo regional.

BULLETIN BOARD

BASKETBALL

HOOPSTERS SEEKING PLAYERS: The Northeast Ohio Hoopsters AAU basketball club is looking for exceptional girls players for the summer season. Tryouts for the 13 and under and 14 and under teams are March 10 from 2 to 5 p.m. at Buckeye High School, March 17 from 2 to 4 p.m. at Medina High and March 22 from 6 to 8 p.m. at Midpark. Try-outs for the 15 and under and 16 and under teams will be March 17 from 4 to 7 p.m. at Medina High, March 22 from 8 to 10 p.m. at Midpark, March 24 from 4 to 6 p.m. at Brunswick High and March 29 from 8 to 10 at Midpark.

MORE SPORTS ON B6

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Elyria Chronicle Telegram, March 07, 1996, Pg. 16, Elyria, Ohio, US

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For Complete contest rules. Send a self address stamped envelope to: Indians Fever Rules, P.O. Box 4006, Elyria, Ohio 44036